

PRESENTATION CONTENT GUIDE

Preparing Your Independent Presentation

Purpose of this document: You will build your own presentation slides (using PowerPoint, Google Slides, or a physical poster/handout if preferred). This guide gives you (1) a universal content structure to follow for any question, and (2) content briefs by question category to help you organize your research and evidence.

PART 1: THE UNIVERSAL SLIDE FRAMEWORK

Every presentation, regardless of assigned question, should follow this eight-part structure. Write your content in full sentences under each heading before building your slides — do not build a slide from a single word or fragment.

1. **Title Slide** — Your name, your assigned question (stated as a clear title, not just copied from the question bank), and one sentence stating your final recommendation up front.
 2. **The Problem** — In 2–3 sentences, state the specific business problem you were assigned, citing the exact section(s) of the case study where the problem is evidenced.
 3. **Why It Matters** — Explain, with a data point or quote from a stakeholder memo, why this problem is urgent or significant for BrightLeaf specifically.
 4. **Root Cause Analysis** — Explain *why* the problem exists, not just that it exists. Distinguish between symptoms (e.g., “revenue is falling”) and causes (e.g., “digital substitution is shrinking the addressable market for planners specifically”).
 5. **Evidence Review** — Present the 2–3 strongest pieces of evidence from the case study that inform your recommendation. Use direct section references (e.g., “Section 7 shows...”).
 6. **Your Recommendation** — State your proposed solution clearly and specifically. Avoid vague recommendations (“focus on marketing more”); be concrete (“launch a 3-month pilot creator partnership targeting 3 mid-tier journaling creators, budgeted at X, measured against website traffic and conversion rate”).
 7. **Risks and Tradeoffs** — Every recommendation has a cost or a risk. Name at least one, and explain how you would mitigate it.
 8. **Closing / Call to Action** — One sentence stating what you are asking the founder (or the class, in the debate) to do or decide.
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PART 2: BUILDING YOUR SLIDES

Once your content is written out in full sentences under each of the eight headings above, transfer it to your slides. Keep each slide focused on one idea from the framework — resist the urge to crowd multiple points onto a single slide. A clean, professional business style works best: use a muted, sustainability-appropriate color palette (greens, creams, warm neutrals) consistent with BrightLeaf’s actual brand positioning, and keep text on each slide to short

phrases or bullet points rather than full paragraphs — save your full sentences for what you say aloud, not what’s on the screen.

You are responsible for the accuracy of everything on your slides. Every claim on an evidence or recommendation slide should be traceable back to a specific section of the case study, exactly as CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.RI.1 requires you to ground claims in the text. Do not include statistics, quotes, or claims that are not actually supported by the case study document.

PART 3: CONTENT BRIEFS BY QUESTION CATEGORY

Use the brief matching your assigned question’s category from the question bank as a starting point for Parts 4–6 of the universal framework above (Root Cause, Evidence, Recommendation). Adapt the brief to your specific question rather than copying it directly.

Marketing / Communications questions: Anchor your evidence in Sections 7, 8, 15, and 16 (customer research, marketing history, media perception, and verbatim themes). Your recommendation should specify audience, channel, and message — not just “do more marketing.”

Finance / Strategy questions: Anchor your evidence in Sections 6, 9, 12, and 18 (financial data, the three offers, risk factors, and the finance team’s open questions). Your recommendation should reference the 14-month cash runway explicitly and explain how your plan fits within it.

Product / Operations questions: Anchor your evidence in Sections 3, 4, 11, and 17 (product line, industry landscape, workforce, and expansion). Your recommendation should address production capacity and workforce implications, not just the product idea itself.

People / Human Factors questions: Anchor your evidence in Sections 7, 10, 11, and 16 (customer segments, sustainability practice, workforce, and qualitative research themes). Your recommendation should name a specific segment or group and explain what changes for them.

Deal-Structuring questions: Anchor your evidence in Section 9 (the relevant stakeholder memo) and Section 12 (risk factors). Your recommendation should be a specific list of proposed contract terms, not a general opinion on the deal.

Capstone question: Draw evidence from at least five different sections of the case study. Your recommendation must explicitly weigh all three offers against each other, not just argue for one in isolation.

PART 4: WHAT MAKES A STRONG VS. WEAK SLIDE DECK

Weak	Strong
“BrightLeaf should market to young people more.”	“BrightLeaf should fund a 3-creator, 3-month pilot targeting the under-25 segment, whose repeat-purchase rate (41%, Section 7) is the lowest of any segment — meaning

Weak	Strong
A slide with no case study citation	acquisition alone won't fix the problem without a paired retention offer."
Recommendation with no risk acknowledged	A slide with a specific section number and data point on every claim slide
A slide crowded with paragraphs of text	Recommendation paired with a named risk and a specific mitigation step
	Short, focused slides that support what you say aloud rather than replace it

Bring your finalized slides and your Physical Notes to your presentation slot. You will present for approximately 3–4 minutes and should be prepared for 1–2 follow-up questions from the teacher or classmates.